

SENATE No. 118**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

Sal N. DiDomenico

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act lifting kids out of deep poverty.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Sal N. DiDomenico</i>	<i>Middlesex and Suffolk</i>	
<i>Carmine Lawrence Gentile</i>	<i>13th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/22/2025</i>
<i>Joanne M. Comerford</i>	<i>Hampshire, Franklin and Worcester</i>	<i>1/29/2025</i>
<i>Mark C. Montigny</i>	<i>Second Bristol and Plymouth</i>	<i>1/29/2025</i>
<i>Michael D. Brady</i>	<i>Second Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>1/30/2025</i>
<i>Michael J. Barrett</i>	<i>Third Middlesex</i>	<i>2/4/2025</i>
<i>Jason M. Lewis</i>	<i>Fifth Middlesex</i>	<i>2/4/2025</i>
<i>Paul W. Mark</i>	<i>Berkshire, Hampden, Franklin and Hampshire</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Cindy F. Friedman</i>	<i>Fourth Middlesex</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Michael F. Rush</i>	<i>Norfolk and Suffolk</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Julian Cyr</i>	<i>Cape and Islands</i>	<i>2/18/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/18/2025</i>
<i>Patricia D. Jehlen</i>	<i>Second Middlesex</i>	<i>2/19/2025</i>
<i>Adam Gómez</i>	<i>Hampden</i>	<i>2/20/2025</i>
<i>John F. Keenan</i>	<i>Norfolk and Plymouth</i>	<i>2/21/2025</i>
<i>Thomas M. Stanley</i>	<i>9th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/25/2025</i>

<i>Brendan P. Crighton</i>	<i>Third Essex</i>	<i>3/3/2025</i>
<i>Robyn K. Kennedy</i>	<i>First Worcester</i>	<i>3/5/2025</i>
<i>Michael O. Moore</i>	<i>Second Worcester</i>	<i>3/6/2025</i>
<i>Manny Cruz</i>	<i>7th Essex</i>	<i>3/17/2025</i>
<i>Liz Miranda</i>	<i>Second Suffolk</i>	<i>3/19/2025</i>
<i>Pavel M. Payano</i>	<i>First Essex</i>	<i>4/2/2025</i>
<i>Mike Connolly</i>	<i>26th Middlesex</i>	<i>4/2/2025</i>
<i>Rebecca L. Rausch</i>	<i>Norfolk, Worcester and Middlesex</i>	<i>4/7/2025</i>
<i>Edward J. Kennedy</i>	<i>First Middlesex</i>	<i>4/22/2025</i>
<i>William J. Driscoll, Jr.</i>	<i>Norfolk, Plymouth and Bristol</i>	<i>4/22/2025</i>
<i>Paul R. Feeney</i>	<i>Bristol and Norfolk</i>	<i>4/30/2025</i>
<i>Dylan A. Fernandes</i>	<i>Plymouth and Barnstable</i>	<i>5/5/2025</i>
<i>Lydia Edwards</i>	<i>Third Suffolk</i>	<i>5/21/2025</i>
<i>Nick Collins</i>	<i>First Suffolk</i>	<i>6/4/2025</i>

SENATE No. 118

By Mr. DiDomenico, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 118) of Sal N. DiDomenico, Carmine Lawrence Gentile, Joanne M. Comerford, Mark C. Montigny and other members of the General Court for legislation to lift kids out of deep poverty. Children, Families and Persons with Disabilities.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 75 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act lifting kids out of deep poverty.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Section 2 of chapter 118 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022
2 Official Edition, is hereby amended by striking the fourth paragraph and inserting in place
3 thereof the following new paragraph:- "Notwithstanding any general or special law to the
4 contrary, the payment standards for monthly benefits for the program not including the rental
5 allowance shall be increased effective July first of each year beginning with July 1, 2025 by 20
6 percent above the payment standard in effect in the previous fiscal year until the payment
7 standard for the household size equals 50 percent of the federal poverty level for the household
8 size; provided further, that once the payment standard for the household size equals 50 percent of
9 the federal poverty level for the household size, the payment standard shall be increased effective
10 July first of each year in order that the payment standard shall be no less than 50% of the poverty

level for the household size as determined by the federal Department of Health and Human Services; provided further, that the need standard and the payment amounts shall be further increased by the amount of a clothing allowance in the month for which it is paid and by the rental allowance for households incurring a rent or mortgage expense and not residing in public or subsidized housing."

SECTION 2. Section 1 of chapter 117A of the General Laws is hereby amended by inserting after the first paragraph the following new paragraph:- "Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, the payment standards for monthly benefits for the program shall be increased effective July first of each year beginning with July 1, 2025 by 20 percent above the payment standard in effect in the previous fiscal year until the payment standard for the household size equals 50 percent of the federal poverty level for the household size; provided further, that once the payment standard for the household size equals 50 percent of the federal poverty level for the household size, the payment standard shall be increased effective July first of each year in order that the payment standard shall be no less than 50 percent of the poverty level for the household size as determined by the federal Department of Health and Human Services".